

SIMPLE PAST

PAGE 1

1. What it is and when we use it



1) LOOK AND MATCH



yesterday



What did he do?



last night



What did she watch?



last week



Where did she go?



last year



Who was she with?



2) KEY IDEA



- We use it for actions that started and finished in the past.
- It often appears with a specific or finished time.
- It answers questions such as "What happened?" or "What did you do?"

★ We see the action as complete and finished.



3) TIME EXPRESSIONS

- yesterday
- last night
- two days ago
- on Monday
- last weekend
- last week
- last month
- last year
- in 2024
- the other day
- suddenly
- then
- in the end



4) MAIN USES

FINISHED ACTION



Yesterday I **studied** for two hours.

SEQUENCE OF ACTIONS



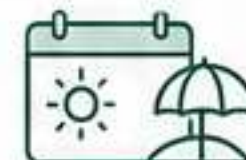
I **got** home, **had** dinner and **went** to bed.

SINGLE EVENT



Suddenly, the phone **rang**.

FINISHED PERIOD



Last summer I **visited** Valencia.



5) MODEL EXAMPLES

- 1 Yesterday I **ate** with my friends.
- 2 Last night I **watched** a film.
- 3 Last week I **had** a lot of work.
- 4 On Saturday we **went** to the market.
- 5 I **arrived** late and **missed** the bus.
- 6 My sister **studied** English in 2024.
- 7 Then I **did** my homework.
- 8 In the end, we **didn't** go out.



6) USEFUL CLASS QUESTIONS



What did you do yesterday?



Where did you go?



Who did you talk to?



What did you eat?



What time did you arrive?



Did you like it?

SIMPLE PAST

2. How regular verbs are formed



1) LOOK AT THE EXAMPLES



Yesterday I **talked** to Anna.



Then I **cooked** at home.



In 2024 I **lived** in Madrid.



Last night I **studied** English.



2) SPELLING RULES

MOST VERBS

work → **worked**

play → **played**

clean → **cleaned**

VERBS ENDING IN -E

live → **lived**

like → **liked**

arrive → **arrived**

CONSONANT + Y

study → **studied**

carry → **carried**

try → **tried**

SHORT CVC VERBS

stop → **stopped**

plan → **planned**

shop → **shopped**



3) NOTICE

1



The past form is the same for every subject: I / you / she / we / they **worked**.

2

Y → IED

Consonant + y changes to -ied, but vowel + y simply adds -ed: **played**.

3



Pronunciation: /t/ **worked**, /d/ **played**, /ɪd/ **wanted**.

4



We use regular past verbs for completed actions.



4) USEFUL STRUCTURES



Yesterday + past verb



Last week + past verb



In 2024 + past verb

→ First..., then..., in the end...

1

Yesterday I **finished** work early.

2

Last week I **visited** my grandmother.

3

In 2024 I **travelled** to Japan.

4

First I **had** breakfast, then I **went** to the gym and in the end I **worked**.

5

Last weekend I **cleaned** the house.

6

Last year I **studied** English.



5) COMMON MISTAKES

Yesterday I **worked**. ✓

Yesterday I **work**. ✗

She **studied**. ✓

She **studyed**. ✗

They **stopped**. ✓

They **stoped**. ✗

We **lived** there in 2021. ✓



6) QUICK QUESTIONS



What did you do yesterday?



Who did you talk to?



What did you cook?



Where did you live?



What did you study?



What time did you arrive?

SIMPLE PAST

3. Frequent irregular verbs

1) LOOK AT THE EXAMPLES



Yesterday I **had** a lot of work.



I **couldn't** go out.



My sister **came** home late.



Then I **made** dinner.

2) NO -ED RULE

Irregular verbs do not follow one spelling rule. Learn the base form and the past form together.

go → went

have → had

do → did

make → made

see → saw

take → took

3) VERY COMMON VERBS

 **go** (go)

I go	I went
You go	You went
He/She/It goes	He/She/It went
They go	They went

 **have** (have)

I have	I had
You have	You had
He/She/It has	He/She/It had
They have	They had

 **do** (do)

I do	I did
You do	You did
He/She/It does	He/She/It did
They do	They did

 **make** (make)

I make	I made
You make	You made
He/She/It makes	He/She/It made
They make	They made

 **see** (see)

I see	I saw
You see	You saw
He/She/It sees	He/She/It saw
They see	They saw

 **come** (come)

I come	I came
You come	You came
He/She/It comes	He/She/It came
They come	They came

 **take** (take)

I take	I took
You take	You took
He/She/It takes	He/She/It took
They take	They took

 **get** (get)

I get	I got
You get	You got
He/She/It gets	He/She/It got
They get	They got

 **give** (give)

I give	I gave
You give	You gave
He/She/It gives	He/She/It gave
They give	They gave

 **find** (find)

I find	I found
You find	You found
He/She/It finds	He/She/It found
They find	They found

★ Special forms to remember: **went, had, did, made, saw, came, took, got, gave, found.**

4) MODEL EXAMPLES

- 1 Yesterday I **had** a lot of work.
- 2 I **couldn't** rest because I was tired.
- 3 My sister **came** home late.
- 4 Then I **made** dinner for everyone.

- 5 We **saw** the news in the morning.
- 6 They **took** the bus to town.
- 7 I **got** a message from Anna.
- 8 He **found** his keys at home.

5) REMEMBER

- Irregular verbs do not add -ed.
- The past form is the same for every subject.
- Learn the most frequent verbs first.
- Make short personal examples to remember them.

6) USEFUL QUESTIONS



What did you do yesterday?



Did you rest?



Did you come to class?



Did you have homework?



What did you take in your bag?



What did you see?

SIMPLE PAST

4. Did, didn't and was / were



1) LOOK AT THESE EXAMPLES



Did you **go** to the cinema?



I **didn't** go out.



Last night I **was** at home.



They **were** very tired.



2) VERY IMPORTANT

QUESTIONS

Did I work?
Did you work?
Did he / she work?
Did we work?
Did they work?

NEGATIVES

I **didn't** work.
You **didn't** work.
He / She **didn't** work.
We **didn't** work.
They **didn't** work.

BE

I / He / She **was**
You / We / They **were**
was not = wasn't
were not = weren't



3) WORD ORDER

Did + subject + BASE VERB?

Wh-word + **did** + subject + BASE VERB?

Subject + **didn't** + BASE VERB.

Did you watch the film?

Where **did** she go?

They **didn't** arrive late.

★ After **did** or **didn't**, always use the base verb.



4) SHORT ANSWERS

DID

Did you call? Yes, I **did**. / No, I **didn't**.

BE

Was she tired? Yes, she **was**. / No, she **wasn't**.

Were they at home? Yes, they **were**. / No, they **weren't**.



5) MODEL EXAMPLES

- 1 Did you go to the park yesterday?
- 2 I **didn't** see Marta.
- 3 Where **did** they stay?
- 4 We **didn't** have time.
- 5 She **was** at work all morning.
- 6 They **were** very happy.
- 7 **Was** he late?
- 8 **Were** you tired after class?



6) REMEMBER



After **DID**: base verb



After **DIDN'T**: base verb



BE does not use **did**.

Did you went? ✗ → Did you go? ✓

She **didn't** saw it. ✗ → She **didn't** see it. ✓

SIMPLE PAST

5. Talking about the past in class



1) LOOK AND ANSWER

yesterday



What did you do yesterday?

last weekend



What did you do last weekend?

the holidays



Where did you go on holiday?

a meal



What did you eat?

a surprise



What surprise did you have?



2) GUIDED QUESTIONS

- | | |
|------------------------------|------------------------------|
| 1 What did you do yesterday? | 6 What did you see? |
| 2 Where did you go? | 7 What did you buy? |
| 3 Who were you with? | 8 Did you like it? |
| 4 What did you eat? | 9 Did you have a good time? |
| 5 What time did you arrive? | 10 What happened in the end? |



3) MODEL ANSWERS

- 1 Yesterday I studied for two hours and then I went out with my friends.
- 2 I went to the cinema with my sister.
- 3 I was with my friends in town.
- 4 I ate pizza and drank a soft drink.
- 5 I got home at half past eight.
- 6 I saw a very funny film.
- 7 I bought a book and a T-shirt.
- 8 Yes, I liked it a lot.
- 9 Yes, I had a great time.
- 10 In the end, we went home by bus.



4) CONNECTORS

first → then → next → after that → in the end

- First
- Then
- Next
- After that
- In the end



5) USEFUL EXPRESSIONS



I had a good time



I loved it



I didn't have time



it was fun



it was boring



I was tired



I bought...



I went home



6) MINI-DIALOGUE



Alex: Hi, Anna. What did you do yesterday?
Anna: I studied in the morning and went to the cinema in the afternoon.
Alex: Who did you go with?
Anna: I went with my sister.

Alex: What film did you see?
Anna: We saw a very funny comedy.
Alex: What did you do next?
Anna: Then we ate pizza and went home by underground. We had a great time!



7) QUICK CHALLENGE



What did you do yesterday?



Where did you go?



Who were you with?



What did you see?



What time did you arrive?



How was it?

SIMPLE PAST

6. Practice 1



A. COMPLETE WITH THE SIMPLE PAST

- 1 Yesterday I _____ early and had breakfast before I left. (get up)
- 2 Last night I _____ a very interesting film. (watch)
- 3 Last year I _____ in Barcelona. (live)
- 4 Last weekend I _____ my grandparents. (visit)
- 5 They _____ at an Italian restaurant last week. (eat)
- 6 You _____ a lot for the exam. (study)
- 7 We _____ to Madrid by train. (go)
- 8 She _____ to her friend on the phone. (talk)
- 9 On Monday the weather _____ very good. (be)
- 10 I _____ my homework and then went out. (do)
- 11 You _____ late to the party. (arrive)
- 12 My parents _____ happy on holiday. (be)



VERB BANK

get up

watch

live

visit

eat

study

go

talk

be

do

arrive



B. CHOOSE THE CORRECT VERB

- 1 Yesterday we _____ to the cinema.
a) go b) went c) will go
- 2 Last night I _____ early.
a) went to bed b) go to bed c) will go to bed
- 3 Last year they _____ in London.
a) live b) lived c) will live
- 4 Last Sunday I _____ paella.
a) eat b) ate c) will eat
- 5 What time _____ you arrive yesterday?
a) do b) did c) will
- 6 We _____ go to the meeting.
a) didn't b) don't c) won't
- 7 She _____ a lot of photos.
a) takes b) took c) will take
- 8 You _____ very well in the exam.
a) did b) do c) will do



C. MATCH

Match each time marker (1–6) with the sentence (a–f) that best matches it.

1 yesterday

☐

a I went to the doctor because my head hurt.

2 last night

☐

b My favourite team won the championship.

3 last weekend

☐

c We went to a Japanese restaurant.

4 last week

☐

d I cleaned the whole house and did the shopping.

5 last year

☐

e I watched a new series.

6 two days ago

☐

f I visited Paris with my parents.



D. WRITE

Write one complete Simple Past sentence for each illustrated situation.



1 What did you do yesterday?



2 What did you watch last night?



3 What did you do last weekend?



4 What did you do last year?



USEFUL WORDS

CONNECTORS

- and
- but
- because
- then
- after that
- first / next / in the end



TIME EXPRESSIONS

- yesterday
- last night
- today
- last weekend
- last week
- last month
- last year
- two days / one week / one month ago



SIMPLE PAST

7. Practice 2



A. CHANGE TO THE PAST

Change these sentences from the present to the Simple Past.

- 1 I study English every day.
- 2 I go to the gym on Mondays.
- 3 I eat fruit in the morning.
- 4 My sister works in a hospital.
- 5 We watch a series at night.
- 6 They live in Madrid.
- 7 You talk to your teacher.
- 8 We read a book every week.



B. PUT THE WORDS IN ORDER

- 1 to / yesterday / cinema / the / went / I
.....
- 2 called / mother / my / last night / me
.....
- 3 the / passed / I / exam
.....
- 4 home / arrived / late / we
.....
- 5 read / whole / the / book / I
.....
- 6 friends / went out / my / with / Friday / on
.....



C. CORRECT THE MISTAKE

These sentences have a mistake in the Simple Past. Correct them.

- 1 Yesterday I eated a pizza. →
- 2 They goed to the beach on Sunday. →
- 3 My sister buyed a car. →
- 4 We knowed the answer. →
- 5 You bringed your bag to class. →
- 6 The teacher gived a good explanation. →



REMEMBER



After *did* or *didn't*, use the base verb.



Regular verbs usually add *-ed*.



Common irregulars: *go-went, eat-ate, buy-bought, know-knew, bring-brought, give-gave*.



Time expressions: *yesterday, last night, last year, in 2024, two days ago*.



Use the Simple Past for completed past actions.



D. MINI STORY

Look at the six pictures and write a short Simple Past story. Use: *first, then, next, after that, in the end*.



- 1 First,
- 2 Then,
- 3 Next,
- 4 In the end,

SIMPLE PAST

8. Reading and comprehension



1) LOOK AT THE STORY

1



Yesterday morning I left home very early.

2



I took the train and arrived in Valencia at eleven.

3



I had lunch at a restaurant and then walked around the centre.

4



At night I went home, had dinner and read for a while.



2) READING

Yesterday was a different day

Yesterday was a different day. I woke up early and made breakfast. Then I left home at half past eight. I went to the station and took the train to Valencia. The journey lasted an hour and I arrived at quarter to eleven. The weather was nice, so I decided to walk around the city centre. I visited the central market and bought some fruit and a book. Then I had lunch at a restaurant near the square. The food was delicious. In the afternoon, I walked through the Turia park and took lots of photos. At seven, I took the train home. When I arrived, I was tired but very happy. I had a light dinner and watched a film. It was a perfect day.

(122 words)



3) TRUE OR FALSE

- | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|
| 1 The person woke up late. | <table border="1"><tr><td>T</td><td>F</td></tr></table> | T | F |
| T | F | | |
| 2 The person went to Valencia by bus. | <table border="1"><tr><td>T</td><td>F</td></tr></table> | T | F |
| T | F | | |
| 3 The person had lunch at a restaurant. | <table border="1"><tr><td>T</td><td>F</td></tr></table> | T | F |
| T | F | | |
| 4 The person visited the central market. | <table border="1"><tr><td>T</td><td>F</td></tr></table> | T | F |
| T | F | | |
| 5 At night, the person went to the cinema. | <table border="1"><tr><td>T</td><td>F</td></tr></table> | T | F |
| T | F | | |



4) ANSWER

1. What time did the person leave home? _____
2. How did the person travel to Valencia? _____
3. What did the person do in the morning? _____
4. What did the person buy at the market? _____
5. What did the person do in the afternoon? _____
6. How did the day end? _____



5) FIND THE VERBS

Find at least 8 Simple Past verbs in the reading and write them.

- | | |
|----------|----------|
| 1. _____ | 5. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 6. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 7. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 8. _____ |



HELP — Useful words from the reading



early



train



station



weather



market



fruit



photos



home

SIMPLE PAST

9. Speaking and writing



1) INTERVIEW YOUR PARTNER

Ask your partner the questions and take notes. Then change roles.

- 1 What did you do after class yesterday?
- 2 What time did you go to bed last night?
- 3 What did you eat for dinner?
- 4 Who were you with yesterday afternoon?
- 5 What did you do last weekend?
- 6 Did you go out on Saturday or Sunday?
- 7 What did you eat on Sunday?
- 8 What plans did you have at the weekend?
- 9 Where did you go on your last holiday?
- 10 What did you like most about your holiday?



TAKE NOTES HERE



2) ROLE PLAYS

Work with a partner. Choose one situation, read your role and speak for 1–2 minutes.



YESTERDAY AFTER CLASS

A Tell your partner what you did after class. Include where you went, who you were with and what you did.

B Listen and ask questions: What? Where? Who with? What time? Why?



YOUR WEEKEND

A Talk about last weekend. Include activities, food, plans and how you felt.

B Listen, ask questions and then summarise your partner's weekend.



YOUR LAST HOLIDAY

A Say where you went, who you were with, what you did and what you liked.

B Listen, ask questions and decide the best part of the holiday.



3) TELL THE STORY

Look at the pictures and tell the story aloud using the Simple Past and time connectors.



In the morning...



Then...



Later...



Next...



At night...



In the end...



first — then — later — next — at night — in the end — finally



4) GUIDED WRITING

Write 80–100 words about your last weekend.



Introduction: When was it? _____



Activities: What did you do? _____



People: Who were you with? _____



Places: Where did you go? _____



Opinion: What did you like most? _____



Ending: How was your weekend? _____



5) EXTRA CHALLENGE

TWO TRUTHS AND A LIE

Write three Simple Past sentences about yesterday or last weekend. Two are true and one is false.

Example:

- Yesterday I went to the cinema with my friends.
- On Saturday I had breakfast on the beach.
- On Sunday I travelled to another country.

Read your sentences. The class guesses the lie.



USEFUL STARTERS



Yesterday...

1

First...

2

Then...

3

Next...



In the end...



I liked...



I didn't like...

10. Answer key



1) ANSWERS — PAGE 6

A) COMPLETE WITH THE SIMPLE PAST

- 1 got up
- 2 watched
- 3 lived
- 4 visited
- 5 ate
- 6 studied
- 7 went
- 8 talked
- 9 was
- 10 did
- 11 arrived
- 12 were

B) CHOOSE THE CORRECT VERB

- 1 went
- 2 went to bed
- 3 lived
- 4 ate
- 5 did
- 6 didn't
- 7 took
- 8 did

C) MATCH

- 1 a
- 2 e
- 3 c
- 4 d
- 5 f
- 6 b

D) WRITE — Possible answers

- 1 I studied English yesterday.
- 2 I watched a comedy last night.
- 3 I went hiking last weekend.
- 4 I travelled to Italy last year.



2) ANSWERS — PAGE 7

A) CHANGE TO THE PAST

- 1 I studied English every day.
- 2 I went to the gym on Mondays.
- 3 I ate fruit in the morning.
- 4 My sister worked in a hospital.
- 5 We watched a series at night.
- 6 They lived in Madrid.
- 7 You talked to your teacher.
- 8 We read a book every week.

B) PUT THE WORDS IN ORDER

- 1 I went to the cinema yesterday.
- 2 My mother called me last night.
- 3 I passed the exam.
- 4 We arrived home late.
- 5 I read the whole book.
- 6 I went out with my friends on Friday.

C) CORRECT THE MISTAKE

- 1 Yesterday I ate a pizza.
- 2 They went to the beach on Sunday.
- 3 My sister bought a car.
- 4 We knew the answer.
- 5 You brought your bag to class.
- 6 The teacher gave a good explanation.

D) MINI STORY — Possible answer

First, Anna arrived at the station. Then she checked in at a hotel. Next, she walked around the city and ate at a café. After that, she relaxed by the sea. In the end, she went home.



3) ANSWERS — PAGE 8

A) TRUE OR FALSE

- 1 F
- 2 F
- 3 T
- 4 T
- 5 F

B) ANSWER

- 1 At half past eight.
- 2 By train.
- 3 The person walked around the centre, visited the market and had lunch.
- 4 Some fruit and a book.
- 5 The person walked through the park and took photos.
- 6 The person went home tired but happy, had dinner and watched a film.

C) SIMPLE PAST VERBS FROM THE TEXT

woke, made, left, went, took, lasted, arrived, decided, visited, bought, had, walked, was, watched



Open answers may vary if they are correct and natural.

